

TYSON'S TIME

THE FIRST 30 DAYS KIT

A calm, practical adjustment plan for your rescue dog's first month home.



Built from one rescue's real first month.

TYSON'S TIME

Welcome home.

When Tyson came home, he didn't need a perfect system. He needed to feel safe. What finally worked wasn't a trick — it was a rhythm: same walk, same words, same calm, every single day. This kit is that rhythm, organized so you can use it from day one.

How to use this kit

- **Read the Roadmap first** (next page). It gives you the shape of the month in two minutes.
- **Print the trackers and checklists** — or keep the PDF on your phone and fill things in anywhere.
- **Take it one day at a time.** Nothing in here is a test. Skipped a day? Just pick the rhythm back up.

What this is: a practical organization and adjustment resource — routines, checklists, and trackers for your dog's first month home.

What this is not: veterinary care, medical advice, or professional behavior treatment. For health concerns or concerning behavior, bring in your veterinarian or a qualified trainer — page 11 helps you prepare for exactly those conversations.

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The 30-Day Roadmap

One month, four focuses. Days are approximate — your dog sets the pace.

Week 1 • Decompress (Days 1–7)

Focus: safety and predictability. Small world: one calm room, short leashed potty trips, no visitors, no big outings.

A win looks like: eating, drinking, sleeping, and one relaxed moment near you.

Week 2 • Rhythm (Days 8–14)

Focus: the daily routine becomes boringly consistent — same wake time, same meal spots, same walk route, same words.

A win looks like: your dog starting to anticipate the routine (waiting at the door, settling at quiet time).

Week 3 • Trust (Days 15–21)

Focus: low-pressure connection — the activities on page 9. Let your dog choose to approach. Keep the routine steady.

A win looks like: softer body language: loose tail, resting near you, taking treats gently from your hand.

Week 4 • Expand (Days 22–30)

Focus: gently widen the world — a new walk street, a calm visitor, short alone-time practice — one new thing at a time, never stacked.

A win looks like: recovering quickly after something new, and returning to calm.

Many adopters find the "3 days / 3 weeks / 3 months" idea a helpful frame: roughly three days to stop feeling overwhelmed, three weeks to learn the routine, three months to feel at home. Treat it as a rough guide, not a schedule your dog must meet.

Decompression & Adjustment Schedule

What to keep small, and when to gently grow it. Move at your dog's pace — it's fine to stay on a row longer.

DAYS	ENVIRONMENT	HANDLING & CONTACT	OUTINGS
1-3	One quiet room + a safe spot (crate or bed) your dog is never bothered in. Low noise, dim evenings.	Let the dog approach you. Sit nearby, read, exist calmly. No baths, no grooming, no guests.	Leashed potty breaks only, same door, same patch of yard or sidewalk.
4-7	Gradual access to more of the home, one room at a time, supervised.	Hand-feed part of meals if the dog is comfortable. Start pairing your voice with good things.	Short, quiet walks at low-traffic times. Same short route every day.
8-14	Normal household sounds return gradually (TV, laundry, deliveries).	Begin gentle touch where your dog enjoys it (often chest or shoulder — watch their response).	Slightly longer walks, still the familiar route. Practice calm door manners.
15-21	Dog moves comfortably through the home. Keep the safe spot sacred.	Trust activities (page 9), short grooming introductions, collar and harness handling practice.	Add one new quiet street or park edge. Observe from a distance your dog can relax at.
22-30	Practice short alone-time sessions; leave calmly, return calmly.	Invite one calm visitor who ignores the dog and lets the dog decide.	One gentle new experience at a time — never stack new place + new people + new dogs.

Rule of thumb: if your dog stops eating, sleeping, or settling after a change — make the world smaller again for a few days. That's progress, not failure.

Daily Rhythm Builder

Consistency beats precision: the *order* of events matters more than exact times. Fill in yours and keep it identical for the first month.

TIME	ANCHOR	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE
_____	Wake & potty	Same door, same words ("let's go out"), calm greeting — no big energy.
_____	Breakfast	Same spot, same bowl. Quiet while eating; nobody touches the bowl.
_____	Morning walk	Same route at the same time. Let sniffing happen — it's how dogs decompress.
_____	Quiet block	Safe-spot rest while you work or do the house. Practice being boring.
_____	Midday check-in	Potty break + two minutes of an easy trust activity (page 9).
_____	Afternoon rest	Newly adopted dogs sleep a lot while they adjust. Let it happen.
_____	Dinner	Same spot, same routine as breakfast.
_____	Evening walk	Shorter and calmer than the morning walk. Wind the day down.
_____	Wind-down	Dim the lights, lower the noise, same phrase ("bedtime"), safe spot.

Our words (everyone uses the same ones)

FOR	WE SAY	FOR	WE SAY
Going out		Safe spot	
Mealtime		All done / settle	

30-Day Consistency Tracker

Check the anchors you kept. The goal is a mostly-full page, not a perfect one.

DAY	AM MEAL	PM MEAL	WALK 1	WALK 2	QUIET TIME	ONE-LINE NOTE
1	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
4	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
6	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
7	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
8	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
9	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
10	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
11	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
12	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
13	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
14	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
15	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
16	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
17	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
18	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
19	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
20	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
21	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
22	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
23	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
24	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
25	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
26	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
27	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
28	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
29	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
30	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	

Home Preparation Checklist

Twenty minutes of setup buys a much calmer first week.

The safe spot

- ☐ Crate or bed in a quiet, low-traffic corner
- ☐ Blanket that will smell like this home
- ☐ Water within reach
- ☐ House rule: nobody bothers the dog here — ever

Supplies ready

- ☐ Food (ask the rescue what the dog eats now — keep it for week 1)
- ☐ Two bowls, leash, well-fitted collar or harness
- ☐ ID tag on from minute one
- ☐ Enzyme cleaner (accidents are normal)
- ☐ A few different treats and one soft toy

Hazard sweep

- ☐ Trash secured; food off counters and low tables
- ☐ Cords, shoes, kids' toys out of reach
- ☐ Houseplants checked and moved if needed
- ☐ Gates or closed doors for off-limits rooms
- ☐ Yard/fence gaps checked; gate latches work

Household agreement

- ☐ Everyone has read the Roadmap (page 3)
- ☐ Same words agreed (page 5)
- ☐ Responsibilities assigned (page 12)
- ☐ Agreement: calm, quiet, no crowding for week 1

If there are kids at home: the first-week rule that works is simple — we let the dog come to us. Sitting on the floor nearby beats reaching, chasing, or hugging.

First Night Checklist

The first night sets the tone. Aim for uneventful.

Arriving home

- ☐ Straight to the potty spot on leash before going inside
- ☐ Quiet walk through only the rooms the dog will use this week
- ☐ Show the safe spot and the water — then stop giving tours
- ☐ Feed a small, unhurried meal (travel nerves shrink appetites)

The evening

- ☐ Keep visitors away tonight — the household is enough
- ☐ Sit nearby without hovering; let the dog watch the new world
- ☐ Last potty break right before bed, same door, same words

Overnight

- ☐ Safe spot where the dog can see or hear a person, if that settles them
- ☐ Expect some whining, pacing, or restlessness — respond with calm, brief reassurance, not excitement
- ☐ Middle-of-the-night potty trip if asked: boring, quiet, straight back to bed

Normal in week one: not eating much, sleeping a lot, hiding, following you everywhere, or ignoring you entirely. **Call your veterinarian** about refusing all food and water beyond a day, vomiting or diarrhea that persists, or anything that worries you — that's what they're for, even in week one.

Ten Trust-Building Activities

Low-pressure ways to become the predictable, good thing in the room. One or two a day is plenty.

ACTIVITY	HOW
1 • The name game	Say the name once, cheerful and soft. Any glance your way earns a treat. Name = good things.
2 • Treat scatter	Scatter a small handful in the grass or on a snuffle mat. Sniffing and foraging is naturally calming.
3 • Sit-with-me time	Sit on the floor with a book. No talking, no reaching. Let the dog choose the distance.
4 • Hand target	Offer a flat palm at nose height. A sniff or touch earns a treat. Builds an easy, consensual hello.
5 • The slow walk	One walk this week has no destination. The dog picks the sniffing spots; you just follow the leash.
6 • Find it	Toss one treat where the dog can see it land and say "find it." Confidence, one treat at a time.
7 • Grooming hello	One slow brush stroke where they like touch, then stop. Ending early is the point.
8 • Dinner puzzle	Feed part of a meal from a food puzzle, snuffle mat, or rolled towel. Working for food is satisfying.
9 • Watch the world	Sit together somewhere quiet and just watch — a porch, a window, a parked car. Calm company, zero demands.
10 • The choice test	Pause petting after a few seconds. If the dog leans in, continue. If they move away, respect it. This one teaches <i>you</i> .

Observation Log

When something startles, worries, or delights your dog — jot it down. Patterns you record now make conversations with your vet or trainer far more useful.

DATE	SITUATION (WHAT WAS HAPPENING)	WHAT I NOTICED	WHAT HELPED

Bring this page with you: "he startles at X and settles with Y" is exactly the kind of note veterinarians and trainers can work with — far better than trying to remember three weeks at once.

Questions for Your Vet & Trainer

Book the first vet visit within the first couple of weeks (sooner if the rescue advises it). Walk in with these.

For the veterinarian

- What vaccinations and parasite prevention does this dog need, and when?
- Is the current food appropriate? How should I switch foods safely if needed?
- What's a healthy weight for this dog, and how do we get there?
- Is microchip information registered to me now?
- Anything in the rescue's medical records I should follow up on?
- What symptoms should make me call you immediately?
- When is spay/neuter appropriate, if not done?

For a qualified trainer

- Does what I'm seeing look like normal adjustment, or should we work on it now?
- How do I build alone-time tolerance without making it worse?
- What should I do in the moment when my dog startles or freezes?
- How do I introduce new people (and other animals) at my dog's pace?
- What equipment do you recommend for walks — and what should I avoid?
- What would make you say "bring in a veterinary behavior professional"?

Their answers / my notes

Household Rules & Responsibilities

Dogs relax faster when every human is predictable in the same way. Decide together, write it down, stick to it for 30 days.

House rules (circle YES or NO — no "sometimes" for the first month)

Allowed on the couch?	YES / NO	Allowed in bedrooms?	YES / NO
Fed from the table?	YES / NO	Allowed to greet at the door?	YES / NO

Who does what

JOB	NAME	BACKUP
Morning feed + walk		
Evening feed + walk		
Midday check-in / potty		
Training minutes + trust activities		
Vet visits + records		
Weekly tracker review (page 13)		

The one rule that isn't optional: the safe spot is sacred. When the dog is on their bed or in their crate, they're off duty — no petting, no calling, no kids. That single rule builds more trust than any trick.

Weekly Progress Tracker

Five minutes at the end of each week. Progress with a rescue is measured in small, quiet moments.



	THIS WEEK'S WIN (HOWEVER SMALL)	HARDEST MOMENT	ONE SMALL THING TO TRY NEXT WEEK
Week 1			
Week 2			
Week 3			
Week 4			

Day 30 reflection

Look back at day one. Write down three things your dog does now that they couldn't — or wouldn't — do then.

What does your dog love that you didn't know a month ago?

The rhythm continues past day 30 — keep the anchors, keep the safe spot sacred, and keep letting your dog choose. You've built the foundation.

Emergency & Important Contacts

Print this page and put it on the fridge. In a stressful moment, nobody wants to search for a phone number.

CONTACT	NAME / CLINIC	PHONE
Primary veterinarian		
24-hour emergency vet		
Rescue / adoption organization		
Trainer / behavior professional		
Pet sitter / backup person		
Microchip company + chip number		

ASPCA Animal Poison Control (US): (888) 426-4435 — 24/7 (a consultation fee may apply).

My dog's essentials

ITEM	DETAILS
Food brand + daily amount	
Medications + schedule	
Known sensitivities / allergies	
Words this dog knows	

Disclaimer & About

Please read: The First 30 Days Kit is an educational and organizational resource for new rescue-dog adopters. It is not veterinary care, medical advice, or professional behavior treatment, and it does not guarantee any specific behavioral outcome — every dog's history and pace are different. Always consult a licensed veterinarian for health concerns and a qualified trainer or veterinary behavior professional for concerning behavior, especially anything involving fear, aggression, or safety. If a dog ever makes you feel unsafe, contact a professional before continuing any plan — including this one.

About Tyson's Time

Tyson is a real rescue. His first month home wasn't about training — it was about safety, patience, and a rhythm repeated every single day. This kit is the plan his family wishes they'd had on day one, organized so yours starts calmer than theirs did.

Support

Questions about your order or the kit? Message [**@tysons_time**](#) on Instagram — replies come from the humans behind the account.

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